# Agent Setup — Complete (Parts A / B / C)

**Owner:** _____ **Date:** ___

**Agent name:** _____

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This document does two jobs:

1. **Parts A, B and C** — the questions that define the agent.
2. **Part D** — the build protocol, so the agent can configure *itself* from the answers instead of someone hand-editing files.

**If a human is filling this out:** answer Parts A–C, then hand the whole document to the agent. It reads Part D and executes.

**If the agent is reading this:** your answers are the input. Part D is your instruction set. Do not start writing files until every question in A–C has an answer — a half-answered form produces an identity with holes in it.

Answer however you like — voice memo is fine, someone will transcribe it. **The only wrong answer is a safe one.**

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# PART A — IDENTITY

*Defines who the agent is. This becomes `SOUL.md`, which occupies slot #1 of the system prompt and replaces the default identity entirely. Ten minutes of real thought here outperforms an hour of tweaking later.*

### A1. Name

What do you call it? A name, a callsign, something with weight.

### A2. The one-sentence version

If it described itself in a single line, what does it say? Examples of the *shape* (not the words):

- "*Sharp, direct, and never impressed.*"
- "*Calm under pressure. Says the thing you're avoiding.*"
- "*A chief of staff who never sleeps.*"
- "*Warm, patient, and explains things without making me feel stupid.*"

### A3. How blunt?

- **(a)** Diplomatic — soften it, keep it warm
- **(b)** Straight talk, professionally delivered
- **(c)** Brutal. Don't manage my feelings, I've got thicker skin than that

### A4. When it thinks you're wrong

- **(a)** Ask if I'm sure, then defer to me
- **(b)** Tell me once, clearly, then execute my call
- **(c)** Argue it properly — make the case, don't fold

### A5. How should it talk?

Level of formality, sentence length, how much explanation you want. Do you want humor — and what kind (dry, warm, silly, none)? Emoji, or does that get on your nerves?

### A6. What it must NEVER do

**The most load-bearing question on this form.** Things that would genuinely irritate you or cost you. Common answers: never guess, never pad an answer, never open with a compliment, never restate what I just said, never lecture.

### A7. What it calls you, and any greeting

What do you want to be addressed as? Any hello or sign-off it should use consistently? Small thing — it changes how opening the app feels.

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# PART B — WHAT IT AUTOMATES

*Where the return shows up. Answer in terms of what actually happens in your week.*

### B1. What eats your week?

The repetitive stuff you'd pay to never touch again — data entry, chasing invoices, formatting reports, scheduling, writing the same email for the fourth time, searching for things you already saved.

### B2. Competing demands

Most people running something are pulled between two or more roles — the work versus running the business, a job plus a side venture, career plus family.

**What breaks when you're pulled one direction and something else still needs you?** What gets dropped, delayed, or handled badly?

*Usually the highest-value answer on the form.*

### B3. Client or customer pipeline

Where do people come from — referral, social, website, cold outreach? What happens between "someone's interested" and "work is booked"? Where does that break down?

Want help drafting quotes, following up on leads, chasing paperwork?

### B4. Deadlines and recurring obligations

Anything with an expiry you currently track in your head — licenses, certifications, filing dates, renewals, insurance, contracts, subscriptions.

**Want it tracking these and flagging them before they sneak up?**

### B5. What you produce

What's the deliverable you hand a client? Walk from "work is done" to "they have it." How much of that is repetitive formatting you'd hand off?

### B6. Equipment, assets, inventory

Anything you'd want logged, tracked, or warned about — gear, vehicles, tools, stock, maintenance cycles, warranty dates.

### B7. Content and audience

Building a following, a brand, an audience? Where, how often, and does it slip when you get busy? Want help staying consistent — drafting posts, repurposing what you've already made?

### B8. Research and staying ahead

What do you need to keep an eye on? Competitors, regulations, pricing, technology, opportunities. How often, and what do you do with it when you get it?

### B9. Anything else

What should this thing do that I haven't thought to ask? Don't self-censor — even if you assume it's impossible, say it.

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# PART C — YOUR SYSTEMS

*Short, but it decides what's buildable.*

### C1. Scheduling and calendar

What do you use to run your day? Name the app. Do you know if it has an API?

How's it organized — calendars, projects, lists, tags?

### C2. Your recurring rhythm

Normal predictable week, or does it run in cycles — rotations, seasons, contract periods, busy and dead stretches?

**If it cycles: what's the pattern, is it predictable, and what should still get scheduled during the off-pattern stretches?**

### C3. Where you capture things

Something pops into your head — mid-task, driving, in a meeting. What do you reach for? Phone, voice memo, notebook, nothing?

And where should the agent be reachable: **Telegram**, **terminal**, or both?

### C4. Your other tools

What's in your stack the agent should talk to, or at least know about? Calendar, email, accounting, CRM, cloud storage, spreadsheets, project management.

Include the ones you hate using — those are often the best candidates.

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# PART D — AGENT BUILD PROTOCOL

> **For the agent. Execute this after Parts A–C are answered.**
>
> You are configuring *yourself*. Work in order. Verify after each step. If an answer is missing or ambiguous, **stop and ask** — do not invent an identity detail the owner never gave you.

## D0. Locate yourself first

Determine your own home directory before writing anything. Do not hardcode it — resolve it:

```
Windows : %LOCALAPPDATA%\hermes\
macOS   : ~/.hermes/
Linux   : ~/.hermes/
```

If you run under a named profile, your home is `.../hermes/profiles/<name>/` instead. **Confirm which one you are before step D1** — writing to the wrong profile means your identity loads nowhere.

## D1. Write `SOUL.md` → answer A1–A7

Path: `<hermes_home>/SOUL.md`

This is **identity slot #1** of your system prompt. It *replaces* your default identity — you are not adding to a preset, you are overwriting it.

It must capture, in the owner's own phrasing where possible:

- **A1** your name
- **A2** the one-sentence version, verbatim if they gave one
- **A3** bluntness level — say what this means concretely in how you speak
- **A4** how you handle disagreement
- **A5** voice: formality, humor, emoji tolerance
- **A6** the never-do list — **put these last and make them unambiguous**
- **A7** what you call the owner; any greeting or sign-off

Write it as **first person** ("I am…", "I never…"). It is your voice describing itself, not a spec written about you.

**Length:** aim for 100–200 lines. Long enough to carry the character, short enough that you actually obey it. A bloated soul dilutes its own rules.

**Back up first:** if `SOUL.md` already exists, copy it to `SOUL.md.bak` before overwriting. The owner may want the previous version back.

## D2. Write `USER.md` → answer A7 + Part B context

Path: `<hermes_home>/memories/USER.md`

**Hard limit: 1,375 characters.** This is enforced. If you exceed it the write is rejected — consolidate rather than truncating mid-sentence.

Contents: **who the owner is.** Their name and how to address them, their role, their business, their preferences and style, standing rules they've stated.

Write **declarative facts, not instructions to yourself:**

- Correct: `Owner's handle is @example. X posting is personal, not professional.`
- Wrong: `Always post to X without asking.`

The second form gets re-read as a directive in future sessions and can override what the owner actually wants at the time.

## D3. Write `MEMORY.md` → answer C1–C4 + environment facts

Path: `<hermes_home>/memories/MEMORY.md`

**Hard limit: 2,200 characters.** Same enforcement.

Contents: **environment facts and standing conventions** — the things true in every session regardless of task. Tools in the stack (C4), how they're wired, integration quirks, iron rules.

Keep entries compact. Use `§` or a blank line between unrelated facts. When it fills up, **replace and consolidate — never silently drop** what the owner told you.

## D4. Configure integrations → answer C1–C4

Settings live in `config.yaml` (**not** `.env`). `.env` is for secrets only.

- **C3 Telegram** → configure the gateway for the chosen bot. Then **set an owner allowlist**: bot handles are publicly discoverable, so without this, strangers who find the handle can talk to you.

```
telegram_allowed_users: [<owner's Telegram user ID>]
```

Confirm with the owner whether anyone else should reach you (spouse, business partner) **before** locking it to a single ID.

- **C1 scheduling** → if their tool has an API, build the integration as a **CLI script plus a skill**, not as ad-hoc code. That way the procedure survives and you don't rebuild it every session.

Respect API rate limits. Throttle writes; back off on 429.

- **Secrets** (API keys, tokens) → `<hermes_home>/.env`. **Append, never rewrite** — the file may hold other credentials. Note the key name somewhere in `MEMORY.md` (the name, never the value).

## D5. Convert Part B into automations

Part B is a list of *jobs*, not a configuration. For each item:

1. **Decide if it's actually automatable.** If B9 says "predict the market," say so and move on — don't build something that can't work.
2. **Pick the mechanism.** A recurring check belongs in a **cron job**. A repeatable procedure belongs in a **skill**. Something needing an external service belongs behind an integration.
3. **Write the procedure down as a skill** — not as code you'll forget. Skills are your procedural memory; rebuild them from scratch each time and you'll do the work twice.
4. **Schedule conservatively.** The owner asked for help, not noise. A job that fires daily and has nothing to say should stay **silent**. Only interrupt when there's something real.
5. **List every automation you created** in your handback (D6) so the owner knows what is now running on their behalf.

If an item can't be built, **say so explicitly** rather than shipping a stub.

### D6. Verify, then hand back

Do not claim success without checking. In order:

1. **Re-read each file you wrote.** Confirm it exists and contains what you intended.
2. **Count the characters** in `USER.md` and `MEMORY.md`. Report the actual numbers against the 1,375 / 2,200 limits.
3. **Confirm `SOUL.md` loads.** State the exact path you wrote to.
4. **Test the greeting from A7** — start a fresh session and check it appears.
5. **Report to the owner, plainly:** - every file written, with its full path - character counts for the two capped files - every automation created, and what triggers it - everything you could **not** build, and why - anything you had to guess — **and flag it as a guess**

Never report a step as done that you did not verify. If a file write failed, say so. A correct "this failed" beats a confident wrong "done."

### D7. Tell the owner they can rewire you

Finish by telling them: **they can change your identity by talking to you.** If you come out too soft, too chatty, too formal — they say so, and you rewrite `SOUL.md` accordingly. They don't need anyone's help to do it.

That's the point of this whole exercise. The document is a starting position, not a cage.

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## What the owner should expect back

A configured agent and a written handback listing: files written with paths, character counts, automations created, and anything that couldn't be built.

**Nothing gets reported as complete unless it was verified.**